AI Bootcamp — Week 4: Coaching Readiness & Certification Gate

Monday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 4, the candidate is cleared for Deep Learning Program (DLP) engagement — meaning they can:

- Deliver the player-coach model in a live pairing session with a Basic Prompting-level developer
- Recognize the difference between real adoption and polite compliance
- Handle the four most common resistance patterns (skeptic, over-truster, identity-protective senior, management blocker)
- Explain EDD, RTCC (WHO/WHAT/WHY/HOW), the load-bearing rule, and the Prompt/Harness/Model framework clearly to a developer who has never heard of any of them
- Produce artifacts that a client can use after the Embedded Engineer is gone
- Articulate the full DLP arc: two 6-week loops, 6 Trainer sessions landing at weeks 1/3/5/7/9/11, the introduce-then-reinforce cadence, the transfer model (workspace to real codebase), and the Stage 3 to Stage 4 trajectory
- Operate their half of the two-person delivery model: Trainer touchpoints, escalation rules, and the Week 12 joint rubric
- Pass the Certification Gate

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TIMING

- **Monday–Friday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each day)

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MONDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): THE PLAYER-COACH MODEL

9:00 – 11:00 AM — WHAT THE PLAYER-COACH IS (AND ISN'T)

An Embedded Engineer is not a trainer, not a consultant, and not a developer-for-hire. They are a player-coach: they do real work *alongside* the client team, making the learning visible in the actual codebase.

Key discipline: A chapter ahead, not a textbook ahead. The Embedded Engineer operates at the edge of their own capability, not from a position of complete mastery. This is honest, and it is what makes the coaching credible.

Exercise: Read the EE Playbook (`../AI-Deep-Learning-Program/Embedded Engineer/EE-Playbook.md`), the field-tested coaching plays from Wave 1 Embedded Engineers: Rough Process Mapping, Divide and Conquer, Goals → Measures → Actions, An Exercise After Each Workshop, Build Your Own SDLC Pipeline, Everyone Gets a Turn at Show-and-Tell, One Meeting One Artifact, and Cross-Pollination. These are the moves that worked on real engagements.

Discussion: Which two plays would you reach for first, and why? Which play addresses a failure mode you have seen on your own teams? What does "good Embedded Engineer presence" look like vs. what fell short?

Discussion: What is the difference between a developer who has learned something and one who is being politely compliant? What does polite compliance look like in practice? How do you distinguish it from real adoption?

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM — TEACHING EDD AND RTCC TO A FIRST-TIME LEARNER

Weeks 1–3 were about doing these disciplines. This week is about teaching them. An Embedded Engineer must be able to explain EDD, RTCC, and the load-bearing rule to a developer who has never encountered formal prompt structure.

Exercise: Prepare a 10-minute explanation of EDD — specifically the Red/Green/Refactor analogy and the load-bearing rule — for a developer who is comfortable with TDD but has never thought about prompts as something you can test. No slides. No jargon from this program. Just clear explanation with a concrete example.

Deliver it to a colleague or instructor. Debrief: what landed? What confused?

12:00 – 1:00 PM — LUNCH

1:00 – 3:00 PM — TEACHING THE EARN-THE-NEXT-STEP PRINCIPLE

A client team will ask: "why aren't we letting the model invoke these skills automatically and automating this yet?" The Embedded Engineer needs a clear, non-defensive answer that speaks to evaluation evidence, the graduation criteria, and the automation spectrum without making the developer feel like they are being held back.

Exercise: Prepare a 5-minute explanation (no slides, conversational) of:

- Why the DLP starts with skills that have `disable-model-invocation: true` , invoked explicitly
- What the three graduation criteria are for enabling model invocation, and why 3+ documented EDD iteration cycles must come first

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- Why adversarial agents and bounded agents come after evaluation evidence exists, at a conceptual level, without getting into implementation

Deliver it. Debrief: did it feel like a clear answer or a rationale? There is a difference.

3:00 – 5:00 PM — ARTIFACTS: ARE THEY TRANSFERABLE?

Concept: Every artifact the Embedded Engineer commits must survive their departure. A skill file that only works because the Embedded Engineer is there to explain it is not a passing artifact.

Artifact review checklist:

- Is it committed and in the right location?
- Does it have a comment header explaining what it is, what it does, and when to use it?
- Does the comment header reference the EC test file so someone can verify it?
- Has it been tested by someone other than the Embedded Engineer?
- Would a new developer on this team know it exists and know how to use it?

Begin applying this checklist to your Week 1–3 artifacts. Note failures. These will be fixed on Day 3.

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